Biting

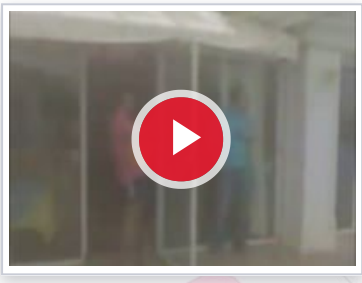
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BDT 2009/2013 · Featuring Ash, Boggy, Charlie, Paddy & Harbo

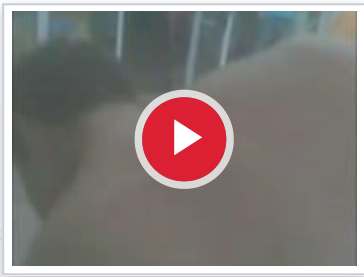
Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

Ah, biting! In the build up to every tour the pre-tour banter generally involves the two teams laying bait in an attempt to extract the biggest "bite" from the other.

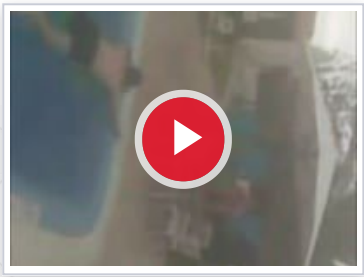
Baiting emails were undoubtedly at their peak in the 2000s and, on BDT 2009, culminated in Ash and Boggy having to do a race before the DGC on inflatable crocodiles by way of punishment for their incessant biting!



▶ **Watch:** The Crocodile Race – Part 1



▶ **Watch:** The Bite-Off!



▶ **Watch:** The Crocodile Race – Part 2

There is, of course, some debate over what actually constitutes a bite, as demonstrated by this email chain from April 2013 in the build-up to BDT 2013. By way of background Fred had had to withdraw from the tour which led to the introduction of a last-minute virgin in Rob:



PADDY

"Evening Dogs - New Tourist

Unfortunately, due to an unavoidable clash of dates, Fred has had to pull out of tour. This is obviously a blow for Fred and he will be sadly missed on tour, on and off the course.

This means that we are welcoming on tour yet another sibling, Mr Roooooooobert Parish, brother of Chaaaaaaaarles! Rob will replace Fred on the Retriever team and (after a handicap dispute the like of which has not been seen since the 2005 Vilamoura tour!) will be playing off 20.

Four sets of brothers, all on opposite teams, should make for a very spicy tour this year....

This also means that for the first time since the 2003 La Manga tour we have three Virgins to pick on. Virgins: beware the Opening Ceremony.

Fred was the appointed captain for the Retriever side so at this late stage the Committee has decided that I should replace Fred as Retriever captain facing off against Langers no Wangers for the Bloodhounds."

Cue an immediate "bite" from Ash:



ASH

"Just to be clear on the 'handicap dispute', it can be summarised as follows:

- Rob claimed 19.

- The Retriever members of the Committee claimed 22 (for no reason other than Rob is a virgin and that's what the Retrievers do).

- Retrievers eventually came down to 20.

- Bloodhounds claimed 19 (because that's what Rob claimed).

- It went to the vote and guess what? The Retrievers won 4-3.

Would anyone like a breakdown of the votes?

Very much looking forward to seeing whether Rob can play off 20 after the fines he is going to receive at the OC.

Welcome to the BDT Rob!"

Followed by Marshy:


MARSHY

"That is a very clear and well-structured bite."

Then Hursty:


HURSTY

"Buzz

Us Retrievers have been deliberating about which Bloodhound we would most like to play against on Day 1.

Unanimously you get the vote, not because you take your time around the golf course but more that you are a true gentleman and have got progressively worse as a golfer since you joined the BDT back in 2004.

Langers needs to give serious thought as to your partner...."

Ash (biting again):


ASH

"BITE: This is the most pathetic attempt at pre-tour banter I have seen in 12 years on the BDT. Fortunately for us, this year's tour is in Europe, not the US, and so Buzz is highly unlikely to have any distractions from producing some very solid golf.

It's a tough call which of your 3 virgins we would most like to be paired with but we're more bothered about how they're going to cope with the OC than the first tee. Having said that, I'm quite keen to avoid a 6 hour round with Thornton Junior.

Suggest we pair Buzz and Adam together. They can always meet us in Sinatras later."


HURSTY

"Gents

As tour organiser, can I draw your attention to the dress code for Night 1.

Brown shoes, Jeans, white belt, white shirt and tour ties. Jackets for past champions of course.

I am securing evening activities."


BT

"Just normal dress for you then monkey! Let's hope we are going somewhere we don't get seen with that dress code!!!
NEVER BEEN!!"


HURSTY

"Here he is!!
THE Rattlesnake!"


DT

"Don't worry about me Monkey I am here. Not sure where you have been the last 15 years though with that choice of dress for night 1. Where the hell we going dressed like that!

And don't you boys be worrying about Big Buzz, think you will find from the history books we have a winning record!!"

But putting debates about what is and is not a bite to one side, the question that comes to mind is what is the biggest bite in tour history? There are many contenders and everyone will have their own view, but my own personal favourite came on BDT 2013, from Charles (apologies in advance Charlie!).


PADDY

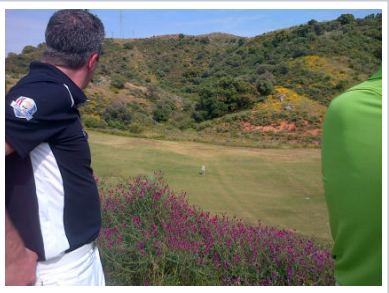
We were staying at Villa el Canine and it was Day II, Round I. Still feeling relatively sprightly, with Gemma's full English breakfast having soaked up some of the previous evening's liquid, the Dogs made the short walk to Alferini for the first day's golf. The first match out was between Ash and Charlie for the Bloodhounds and Harbo and Paddy for the Retrievers. Ash and Charlie were cruising at 2 UP through 14, with Charlie proving an especially tough opponent playing off 27 and throwing in a number of regulation birdies and pars for net eagles.

Feeling a little exasperated, particularly with Harbo playing off just 4, the Retrievers felt a change in tactics was required, and so made the decision to be a little less friendly and chatty with the opposition, invoking the Allan Border Ashes of 1989 mentality.

As luck would have it, an opportunity to unsettle the oppo presented itself on the very next hole. We were on the 15th green where Charlie, once again lying 20 feet from the pin for 2, net 0, for some strange reason put his marker down in front of his ball, rather than behind it. The Retriever pair said nothing but exchanged knowing glances.

Sure enough, when Charlie came to put his ball down, in front of his marker, the two Retrievers were virtually fighting between themselves to get the accusation out first. Charlie did not take it well. In fact he took it like a lump of sh*t in the face.

After a heated discussion which lasted a good minute, involving much righteous indignation from Charlie, he moved his ball back a little to satisfy the Retrievers ("Are you ok with that boys? Are you sure?!") and stood over his putt, with his head on the point of falling off his shoulders it was shaking that much.


Charlie's Next Tee Shot!

Inevitably the downhill 20-footer rolled a good 35 feet past the hole and, with the Retrievers desperately trying not to snigger and Ash simultaneously trying to reattach Charlie's head, Charlie gave his next putt all of two seconds attention and it barely made it half way back to the hole. A four putt later and the Retrievers were back in the game.

With steam still coming out of his ears, Charlie's next tee shot was extraordinary – a fast, angry enormous snap-hook further left than it was in front of us – check out the photo - and all of a sudden the match was all square! The Retrievers went on to secure a comfortable victory which was in no small part down to this rather sizeable bite!